



Challenging Google

Google preparing to challenge Competition Commission on India's anti-competitive directives. <https://dgit.in/nov22-01>



200 MP camera?

Samsung Galaxy S23 Ultra could reportedly feature a 200MP camera. <https://dgit.in/nov22-02>



MICROPLASTICS: EVERYWHERE, EVERYTIME

Is Your Infant Drinking Microplastics?

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A

recent study published in the National Center for Biotechnology Information (NCBI)

revealed the presence of microplastics (MP) in human breast milk. The study also confirmed the lack of links between participants who had MPs in their breastmilk, stating that it is likely that the pollutants infiltrated the human body via the environment. In other words, human exposure to MPs has become inevitable.

With the global production of plastic exceeding 350 million tonnes

per annum, microplastics have previously been found in seafood, water bodies, the blood of animals (such as pigs and cows), and even in the human placenta. This is the latest study in a line of research that proves ingesting MPs has deeper ramifications that can impact the human population as a whole.

Microplastics are defined as bits of plastics smaller than 5 millimeters (or sesame seeds). They can infiltrate human cells via the membrane and cause lasting changes to the body and its functions. As they can also travel within the body, they can trigger multiple cellular responses, leading to a host of diseases.

WHAT DID THE STUDY PROVE?

To determine the extent of MPs in the body, scientists used Raman Micro-spectroscopy, which is a chemical analysis technique used to determine

the composition of specific matter. They found microplastics in the breast milk of 26 out of 34 samples. These microplastics were made of polyethylene, polyvinyl chloride, and polypropylene.



This is a pilot, which means that it is the first of its kind to be conducted, and is also the first in a series to determine how MPs impact infant nutrition as well as the health of the mother. Researchers collected breastmilk samples a full week after